

The Advocate Circuit

Oct 2026

IBM Quantum

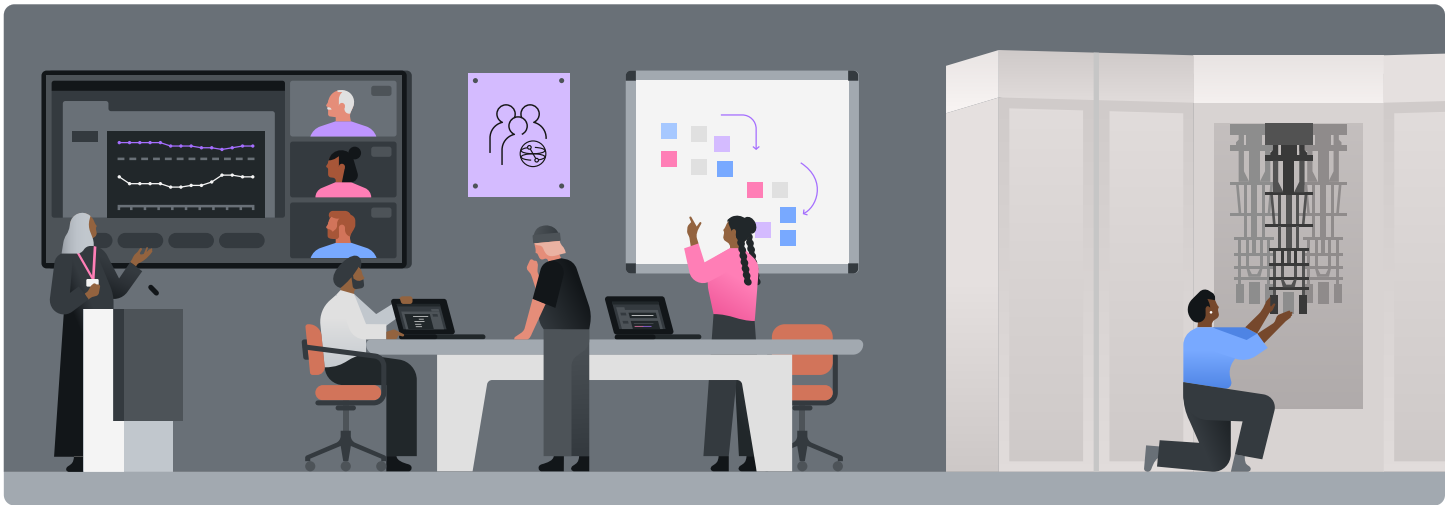
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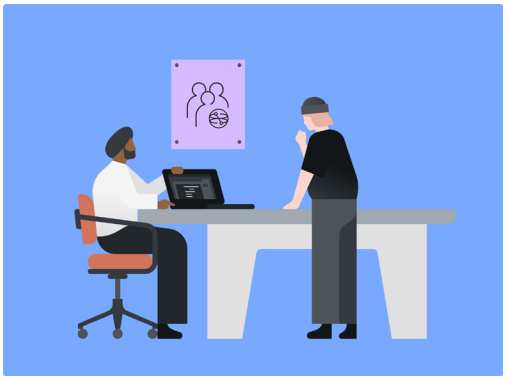
What’s New?

Welcome to The Advocate Circuit, your go-to source for the latest updates, announcements, and opportunities in the Qiskit advocate program and Qiskit community!

In this newsletter, we will be updating you on QAMP 2026, the 2H Qiskit advocate study group initiative that is wrapping up, Qiskit Fall Fest 2026, and highlight some of the recent releases and updates from Qiskit and IBM Quantum.

Let’s dive in!





Qiskit Fall Fest 2026

The Qiskit Fall Fest events are back for 2026! For the past six years, Qiskit Fall Fest has brought quantum computing to local communities around the world through events planned by university students and volunteer hosts, with support from IBM Quantum.

With these local events, student and volunteer leaders are given the opportunity to host their very own quantum computing event on their campus with the goal to grow the quantum community using resources and guidance from IBM.

This year's theme celebrates 10 years of IBM quantum computing on the cloud and a decade of making quantum computing more accessible to people everywhere.

From workshops and challenges to hackathons and community events, there are plenty of ways to learn quantum computing, explore Qiskit, and meet others in the quantum community. Find a virtual or in-person event that fits your schedule and skill level. Sign up via this link.

Qiskit v2.X Developer Certification exam study groups update

Our 3-month Qiskit v2.X Developer Certification exam study group initiative for 2H 2026 has officially come to a close, and what an incredible journey it has been! We are so proud of the dedication, curiosity, and collaborative spirit that our Qiskit advocates brought to this initiative every step of the way.

Over the past three months, we witnessed great moments, from shared problem-solving sessions to the kind of genuine connections that only form when passionate people work toward a common goal. This initiative was designed to create a space where Qiskit advocates could learn from one another, tackle challenges as a team, and grow together as a community, and we are thrilled to say that is exactly what's happened.

As we wrap up the program on 16 October there are a few important next steps to keep in mind:

Keep preparing: The study group may be ending, but your certification journey does not have to. Keep pushing toward taking the Qiskit exam and achieving your goals.

Submit the closing form: Please submit the closing form *individually* by Monday 19 October 2026 (anywhere on Earth) to finalize your group's involvement, share your feedback on the initiative, and request your voucher.

Claim your points: Do not forget to claim your points for active participation in your study group!



QAMP 2026

We are approaching the most exciting time of the year for advocates: QAMP!

The Qiskit advocate mentorship program (QAMP) is a 3-month initiative in the Qiskit advocate program starting on 17 November. It is designed to support growth and collaboration within our vibrant open-source community. QAMP gives mentors and mentees a platform to work on open-source development and content creation using Qiskit, while also contributing to the broader quantum computing landscape. Whether you are an experienced Qiskit developer looking to sharpen your skills, or you want to make your first pull request (PR) to the Qiskit ecosystem, this is a fantastic opportunity.

QAMP 2025 highlights

Across 50 projects, QAMP 2025 produced:

- at least 8 contributions to the Qiskit SDK or Qiskit ecosystem
- 18 software packages built on top of Qiskit
- at least 7 papers (preprint, peer-reviewed, or conference)
- new educational content for the community from 9 projects

39 of the 50 projects used IBM QPUs.

Eligibility criteria:

Mentees: Only Qiskit advocates at Tier 1 or higher can join QAMP as mentees. QAMP admins may make exceptions, but only by invitation. Please do not request an exception.

Mentors:

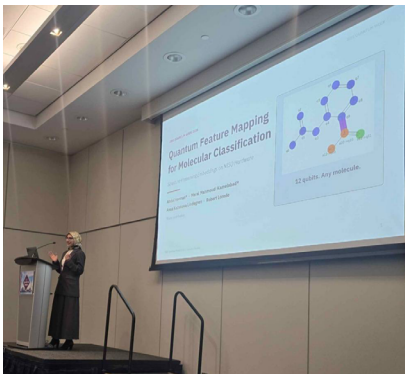
- Subject matter experts from IBM Quantum or an IBM Quantum Network member who are not Qiskit advocates, and who have either worked in the project topic for 3+ years, and/or are currently pursuing or have acquired a PhD in the field
- Qiskit advocates at Tier 1 or higher who are subject matter experts in the project topic

Exceptions may be granted in very specific cases, solely at the discretion of QAMP admins.

Not eligible to participate in QAMP this year?

Don’t fret! If you have a project idea, or something you’ve been wanting to learn, find like-minded advocates by posting in the #qiskit-chats or #quantum-chats forum channels. You may work on a project in your own time, with your own parameters. This will give you collaboration practice, among other skills, and prepare you for participating in future QAMP cohorts. We encourage you to work on ideas that will earn you advocate points.





Photos: Maral from Project 10 presenting at IEEE Quantum Week

And, as a bonus, if by the end of February 2027 you have a concrete outcome, minimal viable product (MVP), or deliverable, QAP admins may give you a platform to showcase your work to the rest of the advocate community!

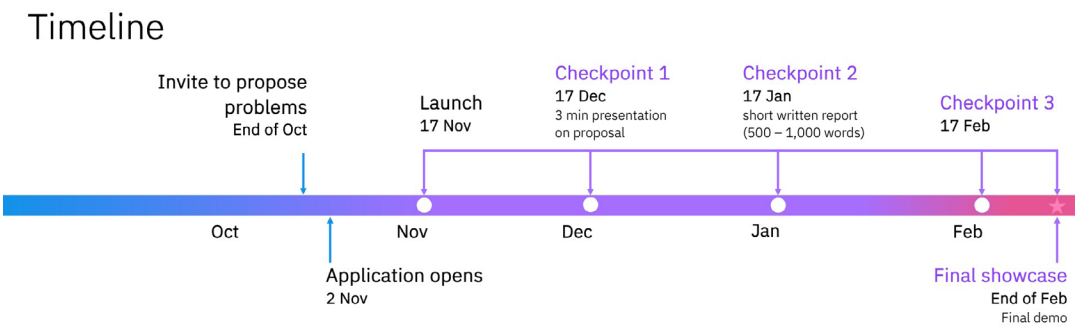
Learn more:
To learn more about QAMP, submit proposals, or sign up as a mentor or mentee, keep an eye on these links, which will go live when QAMP is announced:

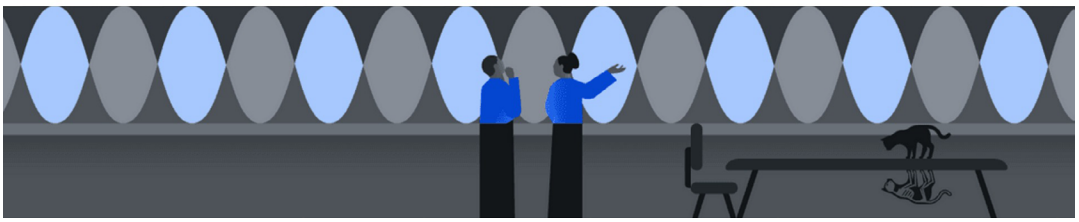
- #qamp-announcements in the Qiskit advocate hub on Discord
- QAMP 2026 GitHub repo

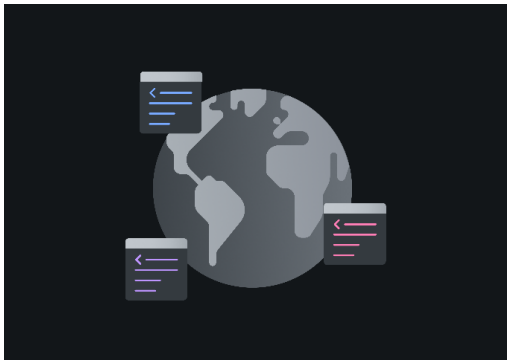
We look forward to seeing your participation in QAMP and the exciting projects that will emerge.
Please wait until QAMP 2026 is announced for more details.

However, should you have any questions, please reach out in the #qap-support channel in the Qiskit advocate hub on Discord.

Image: Tentative timeline for QAMP2026. Dates subject to change.







Recent IBM Quantum and Qiskit SDK Updates

Updates from the Qiskit community:

- Qiskit v2.5 is out! See the release notes for more information.
- A new course on the Qiskit YouTube channel has been released! Tools For Quantum Advantage highlights the tools necessary for getting the most out of modern quantum computers and bringing useful quantum computing to the world. (This course has also been released on the IBM Quantum Learning platform.)
- All lectures from QGSS 2026 are now available on-demand on the Qiskit YouTube channel!

Updates from IBM Quantum:

- The Quantum Developer Conference (QDC) 2026 is happening soon! Look out for announcements around 11-13 November - we'll keep you updated in the advocate hub on Discord.
- Badges have been released for the IBM Quantum Learning courses Use a Quantum Computer Today and Quantum Computing in Practice! Advocate points can be earned on obtaining these badges.
- Learning pathways are now available on IBM Quantum Learning, designed to help learners of all experience levels find the best way to progress through the platform's many courses and tutorials. Check them out, for example the learning pathway built for beginners in quantum computing!
- We've unveiled a new quantum error correction continuum roadmap, a strategic approach to scaling quantum systems by progressively implementing error correction techniques across our hardware. This continuum bridges today's noisy quantum processors to future fault-tolerant machines through incremental advances in both our hardware and software capabilities.